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The National Cyber League
A Community Where Cybersecurity Is a Passion

Aaron Golamb

NCL Spring 2026 Team Game Scouting Report

Dear Aaron Golamb (Team "SANS.edu Guppies"),

Thank you for participating in the National Cyber League (NCL) Spring 2026 Season! Our goal is to prepare the next generation of cybersecurity professionals, and your participation is helping achieve that goal.

The NCL was founded in May 2011 to provide an ongoing virtual training ground for collegiate students to develop, practice, and validate their cybersecurity skills in preparation for further learning, industry certifications, and career readiness. The NCL scenario-based challenges were designed around performance-based exam objectives of CompTIA certifications and are aligned to the National Initiative for Cybersecurity Education (NICE) Cybersecurity Workforce Framework published by the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST).

As you look to a future career in cybersecurity, we hope you find this report to be valuable in both validating skills and identifying areas for improvement across the nine NCL skills categories. You can use this NCL Scouting Report to:

- Validate your skills to employers in any job application or professional portfolio;
- Show case your achievements and strengths by including the Score Card view of your performance as part of your résumé or simply sharing the validation link so that others may view the detailed version of this report.

The NCL Spring 2026 Season had 7,520 students/players and 583 faculty/coaches from more than 440 two- and four-year schools & 220 high schools across all 50 U.S. states registered to play. The Individual Game Capture the Flag (CTF) event took place from April 10 through April 12. The Team Game CTF event took place from April 24 through April 26. The games were conducted in real-time for students across the country. You were in the Experienced Students Bracket, consisting of students enrolled in advanced degrees or hold extensive industry working experience.

NCL is powered by Cyber Skyline's cloud-based skills evaluation platform. Cyber Skyline hosted the scenario-driven cybersecurity challenges for players to compete and track their progress in real-time.



To validate this report, please access: cyberskyline.com/report/4FDE4FDNXV5E

Congratulations for your participation in the NCL Spring 2026 Team Game! We hope you will continue to develop your knowledge and skills and make meaningful contributions as part of the Information Security workforce!

Dr. David Zeichick
NCL Commissioner



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CYBER SKYLINE

NATIONAL CYBER LEAGUE SCORE CARD

NCL SPRING 2026 TEAM GAME

**EXPERIENCED
STUDENTS RANK**

**46TH PLACE
OUT OF 341**

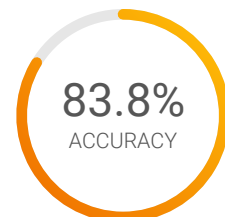
**PERCENTILE
87TH**

YOUR TOP CATEGORIES

**NETWORK TRAFFIC
ANALYSIS
96TH PERCENTILE**

**SCANNING &
RECONNAISSANCE
91ST PERCENTILE**

**WEB APPLICATION
EXPLOITATION
91ST PERCENTILE**



Average: 71.7%

cyberskyline.com/report/4FDE4FDNXV5E

Learn more at nationalcyberleague.org



NCL Spring 2026 Team Game

The NCL Team Game is designed for student players nationwide to compete in realtime in the categories listed below. The Team Game promotes camaraderie and evaluates the collective technical cybersecurity skills of the team members.

46TH PLACE OUT OF 341 EXPERIENCED STUDENTS RANK	2745 POINTS OUT OF 3000 PERFORMANCE SCORE	83.8% ACCURACY	93.8% COMPLETION
87 th Experienced Students Percentile	Average: 1942.6 Points	Average: 71.7%	Average: 68.8%
Cryptography	300 POINTS OUT OF 360	92.9% ACCURACY	COMPLETION: 92.9%
Identify techniques used to encrypt or obfuscate messages and leverage tools to extract the plaintext.			
Enumeration & Exploitation	300 POINTS OUT OF 300	83.3% ACCURACY	COMPLETION: 100.0%
Identify actionable exploits and vulnerabilities and use them to bypass the security measures in code and compiled binaries.			
Forensics	260 POINTS OUT OF 300	65.2% ACCURACY	COMPLETION: 88.2%
Utilize the proper tools and techniques to analyze, process, recover, and/or investigate digital evidence in a computer-related incident.			
Log Analysis	220 POINTS OUT OF 300	59.3% ACCURACY	COMPLETION: 80.0%
Utilize the proper tools and techniques to establish a baseline for normal operation and identify malicious activities using log files from various services.			
Network Traffic Analysis	300 POINTS OUT OF 300	100.0% ACCURACY	COMPLETION: 100.0%
Identify malicious and benign network traffic to demonstrate an understanding of potential security breaches.			
Open Source Intelligence	340 POINTS OUT OF 385	87.2% ACCURACY	COMPLETION: 91.1%
Utilize publicly available information such as search engines, public repositories, social media, and more to gain in-depth knowledge on a topic or target.			
Password Cracking	355 POINTS OUT OF 355	81.3% ACCURACY	COMPLETION: 100.0%
Identify types of password hashes and apply various techniques to efficiently determine plaintext passwords.			
Scanning & Reconnaissance	300 POINTS OUT OF 300	100.0% ACCURACY	COMPLETION: 100.0%
Identify and use the proper tools to gain intelligence about a target including its services and potential vulnerabilities.			
Web Application Exploitation	270 POINTS OUT OF 300	100.0% ACCURACY	COMPLETION: 94.1%
Identify actionable exploits and vulnerabilities and use them to bypass the security measures in online services.			

Note: Survey module (100 points) was excluded from this report.



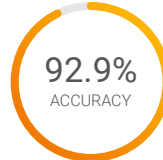


Cryptography Module

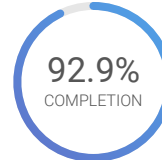
Identify techniques used to encrypt or obfuscate messages and leverage tools to extract the plaintext.

51 ST PLACE
OUT OF 341
EXPERIENCED STUDENTS RANK

300 POINTS
OUT OF 360
PERFORMANCE SCORE



Average: 72.3%



Average: 72.6%

86th Experienced Students
Percentile

Average: 230.1 Points

Paper Chase (Easy)

30 POINTS
OUT OF 30

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Manually extract a flag from an image of a punch card.

Hex password (Easy)

60 POINTS
OUT OF 60

80.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Recover a password that has been XOR-encrypted and encoded in UTF-16.

Decoding (Easy)

60 POINTS
OUT OF 60

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Identify and decrypt different cipher schemes.

Unc's Encryption (Medium)

100 POINTS
OUT OF 100

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Exploit poor implementation of ECDSA signatures through r value reuse.

Collisions (Medium)

50 POINTS
OUT OF 50

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Forge a message that produces a truncated SHA1 hash collision.

Checkpoint (Hard)

0 POINTS
OUT OF 60

0.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **0.0%**

Flip bits in AES-CBC ciphertext to forge a trusted session token.



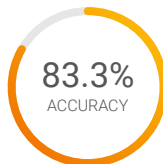


Enumeration & Exploitation Module

Identify actionable exploits and vulnerabilities and use them to bypass the security measures in code and compiled binaries.

46TH PLACE
OUT OF 341
EXPERIENCED STUDENTS RANK

300 POINTS
OUT OF 300
PERFORMANCE SCORE



Average: 80.1%



Average: 76.2%

87th Experienced Students
Percentile

Average: 217.9 Points

Getting into the Router (Easy)

100 POINTS
OUT OF 100

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Decompile a compiled python library and fix the bugs in it to retrieve the correct password.

Casserole (Medium)

100 POINTS
OUT OF 100

83.3%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Craft and execute a shellcode with NOP sleds in order to exploit a binary.

Malware Sample (Hard)

100 POINTS
OUT OF 100

71.4%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

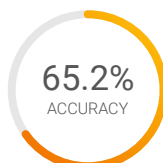
Chain a buffer overflow with a use-after-free vulnerability to bypass a software MTE simulator protecting a DGA botnet client.

Forensics Module

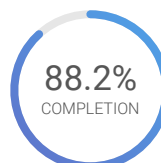
Utilize the proper tools and techniques to analyze, process, recover, and/or investigate digital evidence in a computer-related incident.

53RD PLACE
OUT OF 341
EXPERIENCED STUDENTS RANK

260 POINTS
OUT OF 300
PERFORMANCE SCORE



Average: 61.2%



Average: 70.5%

85th Experienced Students
Percentile

Average: 212.1 Points

Parallel (Easy)

100 POINTS
OUT OF 100

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Carve out recursive file embedding in images and files using file signatures.

In Plain Sight (Medium)

100 POINTS
OUT OF 100

71.4%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Identify IoCs and extract a zip file using hex carving from an RTF document.

Reg Recon (Hard)

60 POINTS
OUT OF 100

45.5%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **71.4%**

Identify Indicators of Compromise in Windows registry.



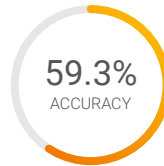


Log Analysis Module

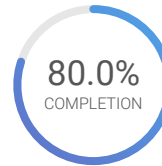
Utilize the proper tools and techniques to establish a baseline for normal operation and identify malicious activities using log files from various services.

83 RD PLACE
OUT OF 341
EXPERIENCED STUDENTS RANK

220 POINTS
OUT OF 300
PERFORMANCE SCORE



Average: 67.6%



Average: 77.5%

76th Experienced Students
Percentile

Average: 220.1 Points

Unwelcome Robots (Easy)

100 POINTS
OUT OF 100

64.3%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Parse Apache combined log format access logs to identify a threat actor.

Falling Off a Log (Medium)

100 POINTS
OUT OF 100

83.3%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Extract information from a common Linux log format.

Survival Bias (Hard)

20 POINTS
OUT OF 100

28.6%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **33.3%**

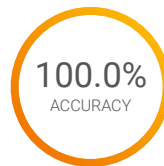
Process and cross reference json logs and provided intelligence to synthesize key information.

Network Traffic Analysis Module

Identify malicious and benign network traffic to demonstrate an understanding of potential security breaches.

17 TH PLACE
OUT OF 341
EXPERIENCED STUDENTS RANK

300 POINTS
OUT OF 300
PERFORMANCE SCORE



Average: 74.8%



Average: 79.1%

96th Experienced Students
Percentile

Average: 238.8 Points

WitSec (Easy)

100 POINTS
OUT OF 100

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Extract an image from HTTP network traffic.

Crafty Communique (Medium)

100 POINTS
OUT OF 100

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Extract information about players and chat messages from Minecraft server packets.

What is on the LAN? (Hard)

100 POINTS
OUT OF 100

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Find specific devices and traffic types on a network from a packet capture.



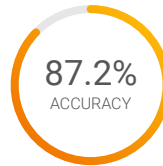


Open Source Intelligence Module

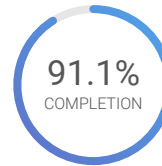
Utilize publicly available information such as search engines, public repositories, social media, and more to gain in-depth knowledge on a topic or target.

65TH PLACE
OUT OF 341
EXPERIENCED STUDENTS RANK

340 POINTS
OUT OF 385
PERFORMANCE SCORE



Average: 70.9%



Average: 76.7%

81st Experienced Students
Percentile

Average: 274.3 Points

Rules of Conduct (Easy)

45 POINTS
OUT OF 45

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Introductory challenge on acceptable conduct during NCL.

MEROPS (Easy)

50 POINTS
OUT OF 50

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Identify key search terms and execute search for information.

ATT&CKED (Easy)

75 POINTS
OUT OF 75

81.8%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Research and distill threat reporting to map adversary Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures (TTPs) to the MITRE ATT&CK framework.

Boarding Pass (Medium)

90 POINTS
OUT OF 90

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Decode a boarding pass barcode and use historical ADS-B data to discover information about a flight.

This Way Pleaaee! (Medium)

35 POINTS
OUT OF 50

75.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **75.0%**

Interpret coded messages to uncover a targeted operation.

Tracking the Tracker (Hard)

45 POINTS
OUT OF 75

57.1%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **57.1%**

Cross reference Kismet GPS/WiFi/BLE logs with publicly available data.



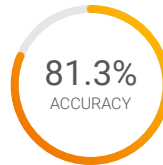


Password Cracking Module

Identify types of password hashes and apply various techniques to efficiently determine plaintext passwords.

54TH PLACE
OUT OF 341
EXPERIENCED STUDENTS RANK

355 POINTS
OUT OF 355
PERFORMANCE SCORE



Average: 81.1%



Average: 77.7%

85th Experienced Students
Percentile

Average: 252.7 Points

ID Me (Easy)

40 POINTS
OUT OF 40

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Identify MD5, SHA256, bcrypt, and JWT strings.

Bitcoin Hashes (Easy)

45 POINTS
OUT OF 45

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Generate random strings and hash them until the output contains the requested characters.

Lightly Seasoned (Easy)

40 POINTS
OUT OF 40

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Use a known plaintext attack to extract a user's password from a database of hashed passwords.

2-Ways (Medium)

50 POINTS
OUT OF 50

62.5%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Crack wireless passwords from packet captures using aircrack-ng and hashcat.

l33t p45\$vv0rc1z (Medium)

100 POINTS
OUT OF 100

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Perform a wordlist attack by generating possible candidates from known behaviors.

Unlocking 2 (Hard)

80 POINTS
OUT OF 80

57.1%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Generate BitLocker recovery key wordlists, crack the key, and decrypt the drive.



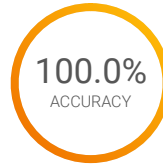


Scanning & Reconnaissance Module

Identify and use the proper tools to gain intelligence about a target including its services and potential vulnerabilities.

33 RD PLACE
OUT OF 341
EXPERIENCED STUDENTS RANK

300 POINTS
OUT OF 300
PERFORMANCE SCORE



Average: 83.9%



Average: 78.4%

91 st Experienced Students
Percentile

Average: 232.8 Points

PrinT Farm (Easy)

100 POINTS
OUT OF 100

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Scan a target to identify vulnerable services and extract information.

Off Topic (Medium)

100 POINTS
OUT OF 100

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Scan an IoT network and subscribe to MQTT topics to identify IoTs.

AppScan (Hard)

100 POINTS
OUT OF 100

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

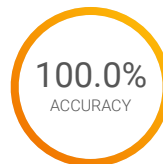
Analyze Static Application Security Testing tool outputs and develop a rule to improve vulnerability detection.

Web Application Exploitation Module

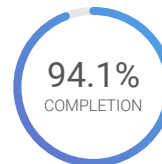
Identify actionable exploits and vulnerabilities and use them to bypass the security measures in online services.

33 RD PLACE
OUT OF 341
EXPERIENCED STUDENTS RANK

270 POINTS
OUT OF 300
PERFORMANCE SCORE



Average: 67.9%



Average: 67.1%

91 st Experienced Students
Percentile

Average: 187.5 Points

Pairs (Easy)

80 POINTS
OUT OF 80

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Identify sensitive data stored in HTML attributes.

Stylish (Medium)

100 POINTS
OUT OF 100

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **100.0%**

Discover and validate a LESS.js Server Side Template Injection (SSTI) vulnerability.

Modern Tech Stack (Hard)

90 POINTS
OUT OF 120

100.0%
ACCURACY

COMPLETION: **88.9%**

Exfiltrate secrets using three advanced web vulnerability classes: type confusion, mutation XSS, and web cache deception.

